

## Your Tax Dollars

Adding to the frustration that we feel is that you and I go to work every day to earn a paycheck that gets eaten up before the next paycheck comes in. Just taking care of the basics is a struggle. The United States is a debtor nation. Credit card debt that never goes away is the invisible money sucker in the room. Some people are spending 90% of their disposable income toward paying off the credit cards and other debts. It is not that we are charging like crazy. It is the fact that they are charging *us* like crazy!

The federal government is aware of the consumer lending crisis, but they refuse to do anything about it. The aggressive and predatory practices of the lenders, and the collectors, are common knowledge. Politics is the name of the game. You and I are not big campaign contributors. The consumer lending industry is. The big credit card banks give big dollars to Washington. In return, Washington lets them get away with murder.

## Predators on the Loose

In 2004, thirty states sued the big banks for predatory practices in their credit card-issuing methods. Thirty states! That would tell a reasonable person that predatory practices were going on. There must not be reasonable people in Washington. What happened? Nothing. The feds defended the banks! The credit card banks continue to pile on the fees, the penalties, and the crazy interest rates. These credit lenders continue to target the college kids and the people who can barely make payments, so they can trap them with minimum payments that will take twenty years to pay off.

The issue of educating our kids about consumer credit falls on the parents alone. At all levels, the public education system does not teach students about managing money. Students graduate from high school, and college, with little if any knowledge about personal finance. With the literally billions of dollars that are spent on education, the government and the teacher's union do nothing to allocate any resources to addressing the credit cancer in America.

Why is that? D-o-l-l-a-r-s. The politicians accept campaign contributions from the large lending institutions, and in return, they agree